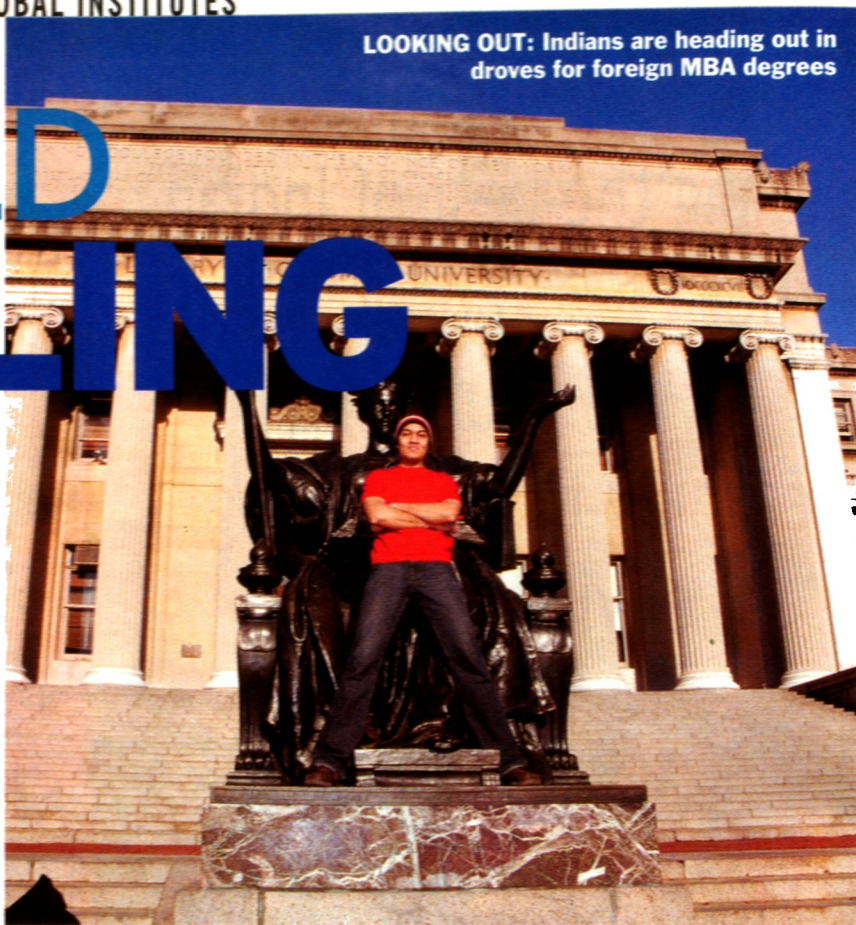


LOOKING OUT: Indians are heading out in droves for foreign MBA degrees

WORLD CALLING

With Indian students making their presence felt as an increasingly mobile community, the top B-schools of the world are going full throttle, offering scholarships, India-centric programmes, incentives and up-to-date modules to lure the aggressive Indian applicant. So take your pick of the very best, but not before you read the fineprint.



HARIKRISHNA KATAGADDA

■ By Shruti Maheshwari

The most popular and all-encompassing degree in the world is getting more coveted than ever. The number of applications to the best management institutes of the world has grown dramatically and so has the colleges' keenness for keeping their MBA programmes relevant and challenging. To get an idea of the demand side of the curve, consider some figures. The Wharton school receives over 15 applications per seat for the 780 seats available in its MBA programme. Of these, approximately 350 seats are taken up by foreign students. The London Business School and the Singapore-based INSEAD receive over 10 applications per seat and these are increasing at a rate of 15 per cent per annum. Now that might not tell us anything about Indian students doing better in the global MBA arena if we don't consider the fact that Indians are the largest community of foreign applicants to these schools, after the Chinese.

So significant are the contributions made by Indians in the capacity of both students and faculty that top-ranked schools like Tuck at Dartmouth have launched an 'India initiative' that

"brings the school closer to this dynamic emerging market," says spokesperson Colin Van Ostern.

Other prominent institutes like the London School of Economics (LSE) have gone full throttle in their India initiative by launching eight new scholarships of £15,000 (Rs 12 lakh) each for Indian graduate students—five of these are named after former Indian president K.R. Narayanan, reveals LSE spokesperson Esther Adediran.

As the degree becomes more relevant, the programme itself is no longer